

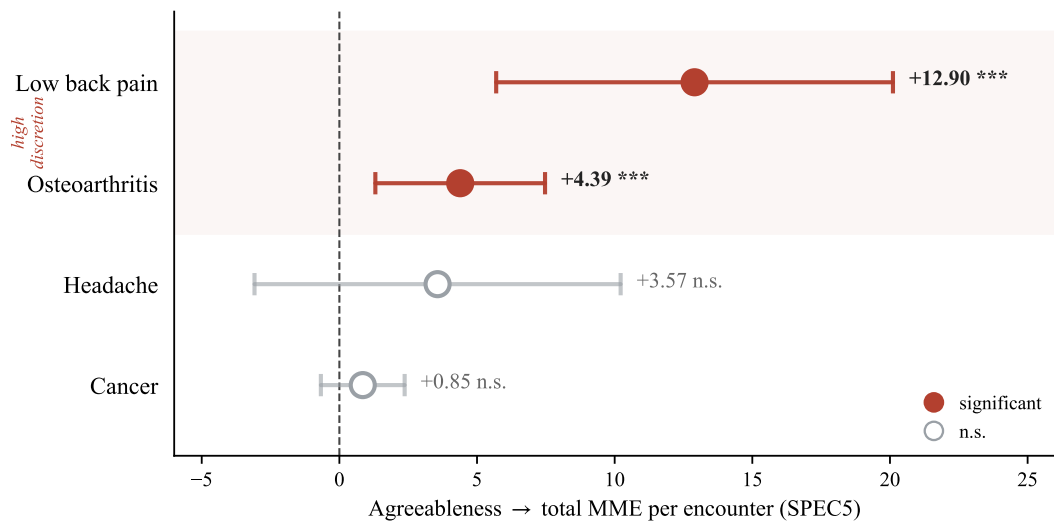


Figure 1: The discretion gradient. Association between LLM-perceived physician agreeableness and total MME per encounter, by clinical-context cohort (OLS, SPEC5 full controls, cluster(np_i_id), trait_l5, 95% CI; Medicare first-pair encounters 2015–2020, af14d window). The signal is significant where the physician has prescribing latitude (low back pain +12.90, osteoarthritis +4.39; both $p < 0.001$) and attenuates to non-significance where opioids are protocolized (headache +3.57) or guideline-indicated (cancer +0.85); a cross-domain placebo (type 2 diabetes metformin, -0.0007 , n.s., binary outcome on a different scale) is null. All estimates are associational.